



interface, but when accessed with a screen reader, it provides feedback through a screen reader. It is compatible with all popular screen readers like NVDA, JAWS, Orca, etc.

Search and discover: No screen required

The platform includes a robust search feature where users can type in the name of a country, city, river, or landmark, and the map finds it. It then guides the user around it using voice feedback. When you 'enter' a location, the navigation is focused within its borders. It's a bit like stepping into a room and feeling around to learn its shape, except you're listening, not touching.

This approach turns abstract concepts like where borders lie or how a mountain range stretches into something tangible.

Why this matters

Inaccessible design often happens by default. But accessible design only happens on purpose. World-Map-Explorer shows what's possible when we lead with inclusion not as a checklist but as a philosophy.

It's not just a map; it's an invitation to look at the world differently, to build for people who've been left out, and to realise that the best innovations aren't always the flashiest. They're the ones that open doors.

Whether you're a teacher, a developer, a student, or just someone who's curious about the world, World-Map-Explorer offers a powerful reminder that technology can be for everyone, when we choose to make it that way.

For the sighted, the easiest way to experience World-Map-Explorer to its fullest potential is to blindfold oneself and navigate the tool through your keyboard. While it may be challenging at first, it will surely provide a brief 'view' into what the visually challenged are missing and how this tool is providing solutions, one destination at a time. Additionally, this acts as a great tool for the visually impaired teachers taking classes for sighted students.

Curious? Use it to experience it!
Visit map.zendalona.com. 

 By: Nigyaasha Shrivastava

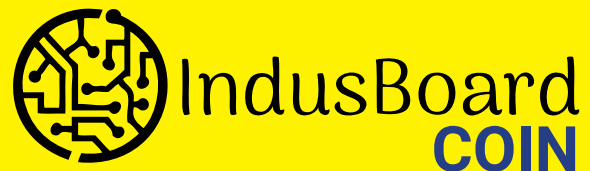
The author is a strategist and a volunteer with Zendalona, a Kerala-based startup focused on accessibility solutions for the visually impaired. She currently works as a value creation advisor for private equity in a global technology consulting firm.

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